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Culture (OWC): [Luguru \(FN32\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1998-1999

Coverage Date: 1998 AD - 1999 AD

Place Coverage

Mgeta and Nyandira, Mvomero, Morogoro Region, Tanzania

Section Title(S)

Performing Power: Sexuality, Work and the Healing Household

At this the three laughed heartily, seemingly unconcerned with the rebelliousness of today's youth. They explained that even their own generation did not possess what was necessary to compel the spirits to bring rain. Many times during that weekend when Babu talked of Mbagho, Lamba and other rainmakers he repeated the phrases, *tumedharau* "we were contemptuous," *miiko yake kubwa* "their taboos are great." In fact, Babu was well known in his youth for his liberal lifestyle, his occasional drinking and carousing. Without going into too much detail, he pointed out that his lifestyle failed to meet the requirements of the healers in his family. Babu told a story of how one of his contemporaries who did try to follow in the footsteps of Mbagho failed miserably. He listed some of the possible mistakes that this man made, bringing bread and tea for the ancestors to [279](#) Mbagho's ritual space at Rudewa, as well as the traditional black sheep, having other lineage members eat the food who were not his joking partners. He described these practices as "jumping (over) the taboos."

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